

Heather N. Williams

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SUMMARY

Pragmatic UX Researcher (5 years in Product/Design). I enjoy untangling messy systems and leaving them simpler than I found them. Day to day that means Jira, SQL and a lot of conversations with the people who use what we build.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

High School

Youngport High School | 2017 — 2020

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

UX Researcher, Cisco

2022-11 — Present | East Stephenstad

- Wrote the PRDs and acceptance criteria for a platform migration affecting 40k users.
- Ran discovery interviews with 6 customers, reshaping the following year's roadmap.
- Redesigned onboarding in Sketch, lifting activation from 30% to 85%.
- Introduced accessibility standards to the design process, taking 40 flows to WCAG AA.

Product Designer

Silverline Data | 2021-04 — 2022-08 | New Brooke

- Negotiated scope with engineering and legal to ship a compliance deadline on time.
- Reduced support contacts by 12% by reworking the checkout and error states.
- Prioritised a backlog for 12 engineers, delivering 5 releases per quarter.

KEY SKILLS

- Jira
- SQL
- TypeScript
- Tableau
- Excel
- Sketch
- Power BI
- Datadog
- C++

OPEN SOURCE

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on SQL.

TypeScript utility library

Open-source helper library for TypeScript, ~100 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

CERTIFICATES

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — Cloud Native Computing Foundation, 2018

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) — Scrum Alliance, 2017

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

"Scheduling strategies for distributed task queues" - co-authored conference paper, 2022.

"Scheduling strategies for distributed task queues" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2021.